

OSC 2026-27 Budget Proposal

Section 1 — Project Overview

What is the title of your proposal?

Paid Open Source Model - Continued

Please describe your whole proposal at high level (Executive Summary)

The Open Source Committee (OSC), in coordination with the Open Source Office (OSO), submits this request for a Cardano Treasury Withdrawal - totaling **4,601,000 ADA** to support structured, performance-based open-source sustainability across the Cardano ecosystem for a **1.5 year execution period**.

Key Objectives & Strategic Impact

- **Sustainable Open-Source Development:** Structured funding for maintainers, maintainer needs, and critical tooling to prevent infrastructure degradation.
- **Security & Risk Mitigation:** Bug bounties and incident monitoring to reduce systemic protocol risk. (Co-managed risk with Intersect Cardano Technology Team)
- **Developer Pipeline & Retention:** Developer Advocacy and related working group(s) to strengthen contributor flow into core repositories and community projects.
- **Ecosystem Stability & Operational Continuity:** Measured funding for strategic events attendance/sponsorship, development metrics tracking, and public reporting.

What's New

Over the course of activating the Paid Open Source Model for the first time, utilizing a 2025 Cardano Treasury withdrawal, The OSC engaged many ecosystem partners to assist with the delivery of multiple programs. Notably, TxPipe, Andamio, STORM Partners, Chinstrap Community. The OSO remains available to continue facilitating support and management of Partnerships via Project Support Services.

TxPipe: agreed to adjust and create a revised version of GitHoney in order to be applicable for the Bug Bounty program.

Andamio provided a low-cost option to manage numerous contracted payments for the Maintainer Retainer program via Smart Contract, explicitly relying upon the Cardano blockchain thereby increasing transaction volume. (Notwithstanding OSC discretion for when to add funds to the Andamio Treasury, each Maintainer onboarded results in a series of 25+ transactions throughout the contracted period.)

Other Program Updates:

- The **Developer Advocate** program was originally and continues to be paid in ADA. This equates to over 30 transactions sourced from this program's payments. In the future, the Developer Advocate Program will always be paid in ADA, in an effort to continue inspiring wider use of and activity on the Cardano Blockchain.

The **Strategic Presence** (formerly Travel and Events) program requires fiat transactions or stablecoin conversion as most travel and sponsorship costs are commonly billed in USD or other TradFi currency. When and where available reimbursement payments are made in ADA.

The OSC seeks to steward treasury spend with additional transactions on the Cardano Blockchain.

NOTE: The execution of the work packages outlined in the proposal is contingent on the IntersectMBO budget proposal's approval.

Why are you the best suited to deliver this work? (Track Record)

The Open Source Committee (OSC) is a decision-making committee at Intersect, bringing together relevant stakeholders from within the Cardano Ecosystem. The purpose of the OSC is to act upon the knowledge and observations of these committee members, and community insights, in order to provide guidance, support, and oversight for Intersect's open source initiatives, ensuring alignment with overall business objectives.

The Open Source Committee acts autonomously supervising and directing actions of Intersect's Open Source Office (OSO). The OSO oversees the management of Intersect maintained projects (Repositories, Teams, & Security), also the methods and processes of the open source development life-cycle. The OSO is also responsible for ensuring that Committee decisions and work streams are aligned with Intersect's mission and strategy.

Open Source Committee Secretary (April 2024 - Current)

Secretary: Terence McCutcheon (Tex) - Intersect, Open Source Office

Current Open Source Committee Members

Georg Link (Chair) - OSC voting member since 2024, OSC Chair since 2026. Linux Foundation CHAOSS Project Cofounder and Governing Board Member.

Udai Solanki (Vice-Chair) - OSC voting member since 2025, OSC vice-chair, Cardano Developer Advocate Cohort 1 and TSC voting member
Bernard Sibanda (Member) - OSC voting member since 2025, Cardano Developer Advocate Cohort 1, Chief Technology Officer: Women In Move Solutions, Coxygen Global, Satoshi Africa.
Jordan Hill (Member) - OSC voting member, Project management professional, Application developer
Reshma Mohan (Member) - OSC voting member since 2025, DRep Pioneer Workshop Leader, Plutus Pioneer Cohort 1, Software Engineer
Sebastian Pabon (Member) - Cardano Community member since 2021. OSC voting member since 2024. andamio.io co-founder.

Former Open Source Committee Members

Chair/Member: Elaine Cardenas
Open Source Office(OSO): Christian Taylor
Committee Seat: Arnaud Bailly - CF
Committee Seat: Philip DiSarro
Chair/Member: Pedro Lucas - 45B
Vice Chair/Member: Adam Dean - DripDropz (DDZ)
Committee Seat: Sandip Pandey - Dquadrant
Committee Seat: Johnny Kelly - Intertree
Committee Seat: Robin Boening
Committee Seat: Nicolas Henin
Committee Seat: Moritz Angermann - IOG

How long will your proposal need to be fully delivered? Or if you are requesting funding for operations, how many months will this budget cover?

18 Months

Section 2 — Alignment to Strategy Framework

To which strategic pillar does your proposal align the most?

Multiple selections:

- **Pillar 1: Infrastructure & Research Excellence** - Keep Cardano secure, fast, and interoperable so it can host more economic activity.
- **Pillar 2: Adoption & Utility** - Driving widespread, non-speculative utility by focusing on high-value industry verticals, superior user experience (UX), and enterprise-grade security.

- **Pillar 3: Governance** - Cardano governance must be hard to capture, easy to use, and paced. This builds directly on Cardano's tripartite model of DReps, Constitutional Committee, and SPOs.security.
- **Pillar 4: Community & Ecosystem Growth** - Driving global engagement through a market-centric approach, cultivating a skilled developer base, and proactively demonstrating ecosystem value.
- **Pillar 5: Ecosystem Sustainability & Resilience** - Ensuring the long-term financial health and operational integrity of the network infrastructure.

Pillar 1, Pillar 2, Pillar 4

Why have you selected those pillars? (Rationale for your selection)

Pillar 1 - Infrastructure & Research Excellence: The Open Source Committee (OSC) serves as authors, editors, and advocates for the Open Source Governance policy for Cardano. This explicitly applies to 'core' repositories owned/managed by Intersect, but is also a suggested approach for repository/project management for any other build in the ecosystem. In coordination with Developer Advocates, community contributors, and the Cardano Ecosystem, the OSC is committed to reviewing and updating the governance policy to improve security, provide clarity, and ensure long-term sustainability.

Pillar 2 - Adoption & Utility: The OSC selected Pillar 2 directly addresses the structural risk of underfunded, volunteer-dependent systems by prioritizing continuous maintenance, tooling support, and developer enablement.

POSM operationalizes this pillar by converting strategy into execution—allocating funding through milestone-based delivery, enforcing accountability, and ensuring that critical projects remain supported over time. This alignment allows the OSC to move from reactive, ad hoc funding toward a predictable, measurable, and scalable model for sustaining the ecosystem.

Pillar 4 - Community & Ecosystem Growth: The Paid Open Source Model not only focuses on sustaining open source, it also serves as direct alignment with OSC's mission to foster development of a 'community-led project'. Each program brings a unique opportunity to grow new contributors within the Cardano ecosystem

Does your proposal support any of the KPIs of the strategy framework?

The Paid Open Source Model (POSM) is structured to convert strategic objectives into measurable outcomes across all funded activities. Each work package defines explicit success metrics and embeds them into milestone-based delivery, ensuring that performance against strategy KPIs is

continuously tracked, validated, and reported.

1. Alignment to Pillar 2 – Sustainability, Reliability, and Ecosystem Health

The core of POSM is the sustained delivery of open source infrastructure through structured funding and oversight.

- *Metrics such as contribution velocity (commits, PRs, issue resolution), security posture (vulnerabilities resolved), and repository governance compliance directly support KPIs tied to ecosystem health and resilience.*
- *The Maintainer Retainer Program ensures continuity of stewardship, reducing reliance on ad hoc or underfunded contributions.*
- *The Tooling Sustainability Program ensures that critical infrastructure remains maintained and aligned with network upgrades, supporting KPIs around reliability and upgrade readiness.*

2. Alignment to Pillar 1 – Growth, Adoption, and Ecosystem Expansion

POSM - Continued includes dedicated mechanisms to grow the developer base and increase meaningful participation in the ecosystem.

- *The Developer Advocate Program and Strategic Presence Program introduce measurable KPIs such as new developers onboarded, contributions generated, and engagement across events and communities.*
- *These programs are designed to convert awareness into contribution, supporting KPIs related to developer growth, time-to-first-contribution, and ecosystem expansion.*
- *Increased contributor activity and improved developer experience directly contribute to broader adoption of Cardano as a development platform.*

3. Alignment to Pillar 4 – Transparency, Reporting, and Governance

A key strength of POSM Programs is rooted in the emphasis on data-driven oversight and accountability.

- *The Development Metrics and Reporting work package establishes a centralized dashboard and reporting function, enabling consistent measurement of ecosystem activity and program effectiveness.*
- *Metrics are standardized across work packages, providing a shared source of truth for governance bodies, including DREPs.*
- *Milestone-based delivery, defined acceptance criteria, and reporting requirements ensure that all funded activities are auditable and tied to measurable outcomes.*

4. Cross-Pillar KPI Integration

Importantly, this proposal does not treat KPIs in isolation. It creates a feedback loop across pillars:

- *Growth (Pillar 1) increases developer activity and contributions.*
- *Sustained funding and maintenance (Pillar 2) ensure those contributions are retained and effective.*
- *Reporting and governance (Pillar 4) measure performance, identify gaps, and inform future*

funding decisions.

Conclusion

This proposal directly supports the KPIs of the strategy framework by embedding measurable outputs across growth, sustainability, and governance. Through POSM, strategic objectives are translated into enforceable, milestone-driven delivery with clear metrics and transparent reporting—ensuring that progress against Pillars 1, 2, and 4 is continuously measured, validated, and aligned with Cardano’s long-term objectives.

Section 3 — Proposer

What's the display name of the proposer?

Open Source Committee (Intersect)

Would you like to link any social media on your proposal page?

<https://x.com/IntersectOSO>

What's the best email an Intersect admin can use to contact you?

open-source-committee@intersectmbo.org

Section 4 — Proposal Details

What ADA to USD conversion rate are you using for your overall proposal?

How can your proposal be broken down in work packages?

Work Package #1

What is the name of this Work Package?

Provide a short, descriptive name for this unit of work (e.g. "WP1 – Node Performance Improvements").

Maintainer Retainer Program

Please describe this Work Package at a high level

The Maintainer Retainer Program focuses on sustaining critical open-source projects within the Cardano ecosystem by providing recurring funding to experienced contributors responsible for their upkeep, ensuring repositories remain secure, regularly updated, and actively developed. It extends beyond code to include documentation, governance, and community support. The Maintainer Retainer Program retains key contributors beyond contractual cycles to preserve knowledge and continuity. The program further enables skilled developers to collaborate with contracted teams, aligning with project direction and strategy, resulting in structured, long-term stewardship of essential repositories across both core Cardano priorities and community-nominated initiatives under OSC oversight.

The Maintainer Retainer Program is designed to ensure long-time maintainers are able to stay if/when dismissed from contracted development teams. The program also allows for skilled developers to step up as new community maintainers and have an opportunity to sit with the contracted development teams, to better understand the direction and build strategy for each project. This results in stewardship of critical open-source repositories—split between Core Cardano priorities and community-nominated projects, overseen by OSC.

The main activities include:

- Promoting the sustainable maintenance of Cardano projects.
- Recruiting community maintainers to join Cardano projects.
- Supporting maintainers who would otherwise leave due to a lack of funding.
- Check the activity of the maintainers under this program to ensure they contribute.
- Establish a payment mechanism to reward the maintainers.
- Disburse payments for active maintainers in the program.
- Monitor the program execution and continuously improve it.

What is this work package intended to achieve? (Core Objectives)

Sustained maintenance of critical Cardano repositories

Adoption of Cardano through trust in the sustainable maintenance of Cardano open-source projects.

Retention of knowledge via financial support for displaced long-time(experienced) maintainers.

Continuity of development activity through guaranteed stewardship of maintainers.

Improved community engagement through community maintainers who focus on creating a welcoming and productive engagement.

Reduced load on core maintainers though a wider contributor base.

Why does this Work Package matter to Cardano? (Expected Value)

The Maintainer Retainer Program matters to Cardano because it ensures the continuous maintenance, stability, and stewardship of critical open-source infrastructure that underpins the ecosystem.

Open-source projects are only as reliable as the maintainers responsible for their upkeep. Without consistent funding, experienced contributors are often forced to disengage, leading to loss of institutional knowledge, increased technical debt, slower issue resolution, and elevated security risk. This program directly mitigates those risks by providing predictable, recurring support to maintainers responsible for critical repositories.

By retaining experienced developers and maintainers the program preserves continuity of development and avoids fragmentation across key projects. At the same time, it creates a structured pathway for new, skilled contributors to step into maintainership roles, expanding the contributor base while maintaining alignment with project direction and standards.

This results in consistently maintained codebases, improved documentation, stronger governance practices, and more responsive issue and security management. Well-maintained repositories reduce friction for developers building on Cardano, improve onboarding experiences, and increase overall confidence in the ecosystem.

In addition, the program replaces fragmented, short-term incentives with a sustainable funding model, enabling open-source contributions to be treated as reliable, ongoing work rather than opportunistic engagement. This strengthens Cardano's position as a credible, enterprise-ready ecosystem that prioritizes long-term infrastructure health and responsible open-source practices.

Ultimately, the Maintainer Retainer Program ensures that critical components of the Cardano ecosystem remain actively maintained, secure, and aligned with network evolution—providing the foundation required for continued innovation, adoption, and ecosystem growth.

How will you measure success for this Work Package? (Metric)

Maintenance activity - Commits, reviews, issues closed per repo per month

Issue and PR velocity - Time to triage issues, Time to PR review/merge (mean/median times)

Security posture - Vulnerabilities resolved, Timely resolution of critical dependencies

Documentation quality - Frequency of documentation updates, release notes, support queries

Governance - Percentage of repositories that satisfy governance standards

Community engagement - New contributors, contribution interactions via issues and discussions

Program compliance - timely submission of reports and participation in review cycles.

Is this a new initiative or a continuation of an existing one?

This is a continuation of delivering a Paid Open Source Model (POSM) for the Cardano ecosystem.

How would you classify the primary nature of this work proposal?

Delivering the Maintainer Retainer program requires Technical, Non-technical, and administrative capabilities.

How will this work package be delivered? *

The OSC is still actively delivering on programs from the 2025 Budget cycle, introducing milestones at this stage could result in unnecessary change requests before the work has had a chance to mature.

What's the budget estimated for this Work Package?

Item #1	
Cost Category	Resources (Labor) ▾
Item Description	Community Maintainers
Item Quantity	40
Unit Cost	3,000 ADA/ maintainer/ month (3000x40x12=1,440,000)
Item total cost	1,440,000 ADA
Item #2	
Cost Category	Infrastructure ▾
Item Description	Andamio Platform Costs
Item Quantity	1
Unit Cost	60k ADA Platform Costs
Item total cost	60,000 ADA
Is there any supporting material you would like to share for this Work Package? Details on the current implementation of the Maintainer Retainer Program can be found on the Open Source (Committee) GitBook page. https://opensourcecommittee.docs.intersectmbo.org/about/paid-open-source-model-posm/maintainer-retainer The current iteration of the Maintainer Retainer Program is publicly visible on Andamio. Payments and signed feedback transactions can be chased on-chain. https://mainnet.app.andamio.io/project/b611fbf3dbcbb9199ee3f3957d3c26e2f99316144392bdc5a244e2f8	

Work Package #2 Tooling Sustainability Program

What is the name of this Work Package?

Tooling Sustainability Program

Please describe this Work Package at a high level

The Tooling Sustainability Program covers the maintenance and improvement of essential open-source tooling within the Cardano ecosystem. It includes widely used infrastructure such as frameworks, wallets, explorers, libraries, and other high-dependency tools that must remain reliable through protocol upgrades and network changes.

The problem we solve is creating trust for builders who need open-source tools to build for the Cardano Blockchain. The focus of the Tooling Sustainability Program is to support open-source practices to improve collaboration and coordination across the Cardano ecosystem. Key outputs are updated and tested tooling, verified compatibility with major protocol updates, and maintained infrastructure that continues to support builders, developers, operators, and users across the ecosystem.

The main activities include:

- Ongoing maintenance
- Upgrade support
- Bug fixes
- Performance improvements
- Targeted technical enhancements

What is this work package intended to achieve? (Core Objectives)

This Work Package is intended to ensure that critical Cardano tooling remains current, reliable, and aligned with the evolution of the network. It focuses on maintaining compatibility across upgrades, addressing gaps in maintenance or ownership, and improving the overall quality and usability of essential tools.

In doing so, it supports a stable and predictable environment for development and operations across the ecosystem.

This Work Package is intended to achieve the following objectives:

- *Trust in the open-source tools needed to build for the Cardano blockchain.*
- *Foster collaboration and coordination through open-source practices as a prerequisite to supporting builders who need essential open-source tools.*
- *Ensure critical Cardano tooling remains current and compatible with hard forks, protocol upgrades, and major ecosystem changes.*
- *Strengthen the reliability, stability, and long-term sustainability of essential open-source infrastructure.*

- Assist with closing development and maintenance gaps in high-demand tools, libraries, and infrastructure.
- Enable the delivery of critical features that improve ecosystem tooling usability and technical capability.
- Support continued builder, developer, operator, and user confidence in the tools that support the Cardano ecosystem.

Why does this Work Package matter to Cardano? (Expected Value)

Open-source practices are an important success factor for the Cardano ecosystem. The Tooling Sustainability Program elevates this awareness and directly supports open-source tools that are needed by builders. Builders depend on a shared layer of tooling that must evolve alongside the network. Without sustained support, these tools become points of failure, introducing friction for developers and risk during upgrades.

By ensuring that critical infrastructure and related tools remain maintained and compatible, this work strengthens ecosystem stability, reduces operational risk, and preserves confidence in the tools that underpin development and usage. The value of this investment is realized in the continuity and reliability of the ecosystem as a whole while fostering trust, transparency, collaboration, and coordination through open-source focus.

How will you measure success for this Work Package? (Metric)

Success will be measured through:

- The number of critical tools updated in alignment with major network upgrades
- The number of maintenance gaps addressed
- Delivery of planned releases within expected timelines
- Reduction of high-severity issues across supported tooling
- Observable usage or adoption of tools funded by this program

How will this work package be delivered? *

The OSC is still actively delivering on programs from the 2025 Budget cycle, introducing milestones at this stage could result in unnecessary change requests before the work has had a chance to mature.

What's the budget estimated for this Work Package?

Item #1	
Cost Category	Infrastructure ▾
Item Description	Structured Project Funding
Item Quantity	10-40 Tools/Projects
Unit Cost	50k-200k ADA per Tool/Project
Item total cost	2,000,000 ADA
Is there any supporting material you would like to share for this Work Package? Tooling Sustainability Program: https://opensourcecommittee.docs.intersectmbo.org/about/paid-open-source-model-posm/tooling-sustainability	

Work Package #3 Program

What is the name of this Work Package? Developer Advocate Program
Please describe this Work Package at a high level To strengthen and scale the Cardano open-source developer ecosystem by transforming developer awareness into active, measurable contributions. Rather than focusing solely on attracting developers, the program is designed to systematically guide them through a structured Contribution Loop (spanning discovery, onboarding, contribution, feedback, and continuous improvement) ensuring they become productive participants in real repositories. Through mentorship, clear pathways, and direct feedback channels into OSO and OSC, the program reduces barriers to entry, supports maintainers, and enhances developer experience. Ultimately, its scope is to build a scalable, global pipeline of contributors and establish a self-reinforcing system that continuously grows the ecosystem's capacity to build and innovate.

The Developer Advocates support existing efforts throughout the Cardano ecosystem, building on open-source principles of collaboration and coordination. They are advocates who help new contributors learn the way of working in the open and building in cooperation with others.

The main activities include:

- Research, manage, and eliminate developer pain points
- Strategic collaboration of various developer communities
- Amplify open-source activities via social media. E.g. Spotlight - Intersect Open Source podcast
- Educate, train, run workshops
- Develop projects
- Onboard and run activities to retain existing developers
- Develop, update materials such as documentation (user manuals and technical docs) on the Developer Portal
- Link OSO and OSC to local, regional events and meetings
- Ensure developers have access to Cardano development languages
- Manage and promote language inclusivity (by region, popularity, dev output etc.)
- Support delivery of Developer Experience strategy as engaged by IO DevRel.

What is this work package intended to achieve? (Core Objectives)

The Developer Advocate Program is intended to increase active participation in the Cardano ecosystem by onboarding, enabling, and retaining developers, while reducing barriers to contribution and improving overall developer experience. It establishes a structured pathway from awareness to contribution, ensuring developers become productive participants in open-source projects and supporting sustained ecosystem growth.

This Work Package is intended to achieve the following objectives:

- *Retention of existing developers*
- *More new developers are onboarded*
- *Geographic distribution of Developer Advocates*
- *Developers issues are identified and addressed*
- *Coordinate/Improve/Manage Cardano open-source communities communication problem with Intersect's Cardano Technology Team*
- *Improve/Manage documentations, developer starter tools such as templates/examples. i.e. speedup development (Dev-Ex repo (Intersect), DevRel (IO), Developer Portal (CF), and other like resources.*
- *Entrepreneurs building on Cardano find sufficient talent availability*
- *Increased developer participation on Core Cardano repositories (Haskell, build relationship with teams developing in other languages)*
- *Have regional representations and thus there is a need to increase the number from 4 to 6.*

Why does this Work Package matter to Cardano? (Expected Value)

The Developer Advocate Program directly addresses the gap between developer awareness and meaningful contribution within the ecosystem.

While Cardano has a strong technical foundation, sustained ecosystem growth depends on a consistent pipeline of developers who are not only aware of the platform, but actively building, contributing, and maintaining projects. Without structured support, many developers face barriers to entry, including unclear onboarding pathways, fragmented documentation, and limited access to guidance or feedback. This program reduces those barriers by providing dedicated resources focused on developer enablement, education, and engagement.

Developer Advocates serve as a bridge between the ecosystem and its contributors. They guide new developers through onboarding, support existing contributors, and identify friction points in tooling, documentation, and workflows. These insights are fed back into the Open Source Office, Open Source Committee, and maintainers, enabling continuous improvement of the developer experience across the ecosystem.

The program also creates a structured and repeatable contribution pipeline—moving developers from initial awareness to active participation in repositories. This increases the number of contributors, improves contribution quality, and strengthens the overall health of open-source projects. Over time, this contributes to stronger maintainership, improved codebases, and a more resilient ecosystem.

In addition, Developer Advocates extend Cardano's global reach by engaging with regional communities, hosting events, and fostering collaboration across different developer groups. This not only increases visibility, but ensures that growth is inclusive, distributed, and aligned with the needs of a diverse, global developer base.

Ultimately, this work package ensures that developer engagement is not left to chance. It provides a structured, measurable approach to growing and sustaining the contributor ecosystem, by supporting ongoing innovation, improving developer experience, and strengthening the long-term viability of Cardano as a platform for building open-source solutions.

- *There is a NEED to boost and increase mainnet developer projects. e.g. <https://cardano.org/apps/leaderboard/>*
- *Cardano repositories are better maintained as sufficient talent is available.*
- *Facilitates creation of more decentralized applications and solutions on testnet/mainnet.*
- *Improves community communication, documents, tooling, social and in-person events and meetings.*
- *Surveys and other feedback provide up to date details on the Developer Experience landscape.*
- *Reach out to different geographic regions to cater for Cardano diverse developer communities.*

How will you measure success for this Work Package? (Metric)

Quantitative Metrics (Quarterly)

- *Total number of new developers Onboarded*
- *Via Github workflows: total number of PRs, Issues, Peer Reviews, commits, dApps, forks, stars, discussions, etc*
- *Total number of meetings, sessions, events, and project support services rendered*
- *Total number of user documentations created, translated, upgraded*
- *Total Spotlight Video Interviews/presentations*
- *Total Spotlight social media likes, subscriptions, etc*
- *Total number of collaborations with worldwide Cardano members doing onboarding work*

Qualitative Metrics

- *Positive feedback on surveys*
- *Positive word of mouth referral, positive feedback on blog posts*
- *Positive feedback on events, meetings, sessions and communication*
- *Collaboration with enterprise organizations*
- *Collaboration with worldwide Cardano members doing onboarding work*
- *Newsletter communication with communities*

How will this work package be delivered? *

The OSC is still actively delivering on programs from the 2025 Budget cycle, introducing milestones at this stage could result in unnecessary change requests before the work has had a chance to mature.

What's the budget estimated for this Work Package?

Item #1

Cost Category	Resources (Labor) ▾
Item Description	<i>Developer Advocates - Part Time Role</i> <i>80hours per month : 5000 Ada</i> <i>30k ADA (~\$7,500) for any tooling or other support for Dev Adv</i>
Item Quantity	<i>6 Dev Advocates for 9 months</i>
Unit Cost	<i>5,000 ADA/month or 45,000 ADA/Dev Adv</i>
Item total cost	<i>270,000 ADA</i>

Item #2

Cost Category

Infrastructure ▾

Item Description

Tooling, Licensing or other support for Dev Advs

Item Quantity

1

Unit Cost

30,000 ADA

Item total cost

30,000 ADA

Is there any supporting material you would like to share for this Work Package?

Github 2025 - 2026 Project Management

<https://github.com/orgs/IntersectMBO/projects/71>

Track Developer Advocates Achievements Reports 2025

<https://493748844-files.gitbook.io/~files/v0/b/gitbook-x-prod.appspot.com/o/spaces%2FLBdnzp0eZpGri9sVpsel%2Fuploads%2FJHd8NHjh7relyJJoNiKn%2FDA%20Q4%20Progress%20Report%20Rev%202.pdf?alt=media&token=8545fae6-efaa-42c7-bf3f-1959bbcbe8ac>

Deliverables Cohort #2

<https://opensourcecommittee.docs.intersectmbo.org/about/paid-open-source-model-posm/developer-advocates/developer-advocate-cohort-1-1/cohort-2-deliverables>

Developer Experience Documentation, Tutorials and Sessions

<https://devex.intersectmbo.org/docs/working-group/sessions/q4-2025/kickoff-orientation/session-notes>

Github

<https://github.com/IntersectMBO/developer-experience/tree/main/DA%20Milestones>

Intersect MBO Videos & Project Spotlight

<https://www.youtube.com/@osointersectmbo/videos>

Work Package #4 Strategic Presence Program

What is the name of this Work Package?

Strategic Presence Program

Please describe this Work Package at a high level

The Strategic Presence Program enables OSC members and representatives to advocate for Cardano's open-source strategy and grow ecosystem awareness, partnerships, and contributions through direct participation in events. It covers attendance and representation at conferences, workshops, meetups, hackathons, and booth activations, including associated travel costs. Beyond attendance, the program supports the design and delivery of workshops and hackathons as a multi-committee effort, ensuring Intersect and the Paid Open Source Program are represented with coherent messaging and materials. A key element is post-event follow-through: converting contacts made at events into active contributors, partners, and informed supporters of the Cardano ecosystem.

The main activities include:

- Funding travel and participation for OSC representatives at ecosystem and relevant external events
- Organizing and co-hosting workshops, hackathons, and meetups
- Developing event materials and logistics in coordination with other committees
- Advocating for Intersect, Cardano's open-source strategy, and the Paid Open Source Program
- Following up with event contacts to convert awareness into contribution and partnership
- Providing expert feedback and advice to ecosystem stakeholders encountered through events

What is this work package intended to achieve? (Core Objectives)

The Strategic Presence Program is intended to increase Cardano's visibility, engagement, and participation across global and regional ecosystems by establishing a consistent and coordinated presence at key events, workshops, hackathons, and industry forums.

Its primary objective is to convert awareness into measurable outcomes such as new contributors, partnerships, program participation, and ecosystem engagement. Thereby creating structured pathways from initial exposure to active involvement in Cardano's open source initiatives. This includes not only attending events, but delivering workshops,

engaging directly with developers and organizations, and ensuring meaningful follow-up after each interaction.

The program also aims to strengthen Intersect's role as a coordination layer across the ecosystem by aligning messaging, initiatives, and participation across committees and stakeholders. This ensures that external engagement reflects Cardano's strategic priorities and that opportunities identified through events are captured and integrated into ongoing programs such as POSM.

- **Enhance Cardano's Strategic Visibility:** Establish Cardano as a leading, credible, and differentiated ecosystem in key global and regional forums.
- **Increase Ecosystem Awareness:** Expand the number of developers, researchers, and enterprises who are aware of Cardano, Intersect, and the programs in the Paid Open Source Model.
- **Drive Conversion from Awareness to Contribution:** Transform event-based exposure into tangible outcomes such as blockchain users, code contributions, proposal submissions, and governance participation.
- **Strengthen Intersect's Role as a Coordination Layer:** Position Intersect committees as the primary interface for innovation, governance, and execution within the Cardano ecosystem.
- **Foster Cross-Committee Collaboration:** Enable coordinated execution across multiple Intersect committees to ensure holistic ecosystem development.
- **Create Sustainable Engagement Pipelines:** Build repeatable systems for onboarding, nurturing, and retaining contributors beyond one-off events.

Why does this Work Package matter to Cardano? (Expected Value)

This work package directly addresses a critical gap in the Cardano blockchain ecosystems: the disconnect between visibility and meaningful contribution.

While Cardano has strong technology and governance foundations, the ecosystem requires structured mechanisms to convert interest into sustained participation. This program ensures that strategic exposure leads to measurable ecosystem growth.

What Will Improve

- Expanded interest Paid Open Source Model programs
- Higher inflow of qualified contributors (developers, governance participants, researchers)
- Increased proposal activity and innovation throughput
- Stronger global positioning of Cardano and Intersect
- Improved feedback loops from external stakeholders
- More effective utilization of Intersect committees as execution units

How will you measure success for this Work Package? (Metric)

Success will be measured through:

- *#/List of events attended (by type: conference / meetup / workshop)*
- *#/List of sessions delivered*
- *#/List of follow-up meetings completed (within 2–4 weeks)*
- *#/List of ongoing threads (Slack/Discord/email chains continuing past initial contact)*
- *#/List of projects expressing interest in: POSM programs*
- *#/List of content pieces published post-event (e.g., LinkedIn posts)*
- *#/List of regions covered (NA / EU / Africa / APAC)*
- *#/List of target segments reached: Developers, enterprises, community builders*

How will this work package be delivered? *

The OSC is still actively delivering on programs from the 2025 Budget cycle, introducing milestones at this stage could result in unnecessary change requests before the work has had a chance to mature.

What's the budget estimated for this Work Package?

Item #1

Cost Category	Operations ▾
Item Description	Ad-hoc Travel/Sponsorship Costs
Item Quantity	50-60 member travel events 1-3 sponsorships
Unit Cost	\$3k USD / individual event ~12k ADA 10-25k USD/ event ~100k ADA
Item total cost	600k ADA

Is there any supporting material you would like to share for this Work Package?

OSC Travel Plan 2025/2026

<https://opensourcecommittee.docs.intersectmbo.org/about/paid-open-source-model-posm/osc-travel-and-events>

Benefit Reports

<https://opensourcecommittee.docs.intersectmbo.org/about/paid-open-source-model-posm/osc-travel-and-events/osc-events>

Work Package #5 Development Metrics & Reporting

What is the name of this Work Package?

Development Metrics and Reporting

Please describe this Work Package at a high level

The Development Metrics and Reporting work package funds the operation and maintenance of a near real-time dashboard that surfaces open-source activity across core Cardano repositories and projects engaged by Intersect OSO/OSC. The program's vision is comprehensive monitoring of all active Cardano projects, with priority given to those falling within the Growth, Maintenance, or Mature phases of the [Project Maturity Tiers \(2025\)](#).

The problem this work package solves is visibility: open-source activity is often invisible to the broader ecosystem. Without centralized metrics and reporting, stakeholders must independently locate and analyze individual repositories and issue trackers. This is a time-consuming and inconsistent process. A dashboard provides a single source of truth, while regular reports interpret the raw data into meaningful insights that allow the Cardano ecosystem to tell its own story: that it is built responsibly, transparently, and with active contributor engagement.

The main activities include:

- Maintaining and hosting the development metrics dashboard
- Onboarding and monitoring eligible projects aligned with Project Maturity Tiers
- Producing regular reports that surface insights on contributor activity, project health, and delivery trends
- Identifying early warning signs of project abandonment or declining maintenance activity
- Supporting accountability and governance reporting for DREPs, community stakeholders, and Intersect bodies
- Measuring program effectiveness and ROI across the Paid Open Source Model

What is this work package intended to achieve? (Core Objectives)

The Development Metrics and Reporting work package is intended to provide a centralized, transparent, and data-driven view of open-source activity across the Cardano ecosystem. It

establishes a single source of truth for tracking project health, contributor activity, and delivery performance, enabling stakeholders to make informed decisions based on consistent and verifiable data.

The program aims to surface meaningful insights from raw development activity by aggregating and analyzing data across repositories, allowing for clear visibility into trends, risks, and areas requiring attention. This includes identifying early signs of declining activity, gaps in maintenance, and opportunities for targeted support.

In addition, the work package supports accountability and performance measurement across programs within the Paid Open Source Model by linking funded activities to observable outcomes. Regular reporting ensures that progress is not only tracked but communicated effectively to governance bodies, including DREPs and the broader community.

Ultimately, this work package ensures that open-source activity within Cardano is measurable, transparent, and actionable—enabling continuous improvement, strategic prioritization, and increased confidence in the ecosystem’s development and sustainability.

- The main outcome is trust in the Cardano blockchain. Trust is built by demonstrating that Cardano ecosystem projects have active open-source development, transparent decision making, collaboration across organizations, and continuous improvement to the code base.
- Offering open-source development data in one place saves everyone in the ecosystem the time and effort from repeating this analysis. The dashboard provides a centralized place for all the data to flow together, giving interested parties a single source of truth about the open-source activity in the Cardano ecosystem. The alternative to a dashboard is to find and analyze individual git repositories and issue trackers.
- Reporting on the data and highlighting insights allows the Cardano ecosystem to tell its own story. The raw activity data requires interpretation and analysis to understand how it shows that the Cardano blockchain is built responsibly, transparently, and thus is trustworthy. The alternative to reports is offering data and risking that the good work done by Cardano builders is not understood or recognized.

Why does this Work Package matter to Cardano? (Expected Value)

Open-source activity is inherently distributed across repositories, teams, and organizations. In its current state, that activity is difficult to interpret at a system level without significant manual effort. This creates blind spots—projects may appear active but lack meaningful progress, while critical dependencies may decline without visibility until they become a risk. The Development Metrics and Reporting work package removes this ambiguity by making ecosystem activity observable in a consistent and structured way.

It also shifts governance from perception to evidence. Funding decisions, program evaluations, and strategic priorities can be grounded in actual development data rather than

assumptions or fragmented signals. This is particularly important for validating the impact of funded programs, identifying underperforming areas, and reinforcing high-value initiatives.

Beyond internal decision-making, the work package plays a key role in external credibility. By surfacing transparent, verifiable data on development activity, Cardano can demonstrate that it is actively maintained, continuously improving, and supported by a functioning open-source community. This is a critical factor for developers, enterprises, and other stakeholders evaluating whether to build on the platform.

- **Adoption by Builders:** The Cardano blockchain needs to attract builders to create more applications and cover more use cases. Regular reports about the open-source activity in the Cardano Ecosystem raise awareness to builders and creates confidence that they can build on top of Cardano but also help shape its future direction. This is a differentiator that we need to actively talk about and the report is how we do this.
- **Sustainability of Work:** Monitoring the work in open-source projects allows early detection of decreased development activity. These early signs of abandonment are important to secure the technological foundation of the Cardano blockchain because they allow proactive stewardship to be put in place.

How will you measure success for this Work Package? (Metric)

1. Coverage & Adoption

- # of projects monitored across maturity tiers (Growth, Maintenance, Mature)
- # of active users (OSC, OSO, DREPs, community) accessing dashboards/reports
- # of governance or program reports referencing these metrics

2. Data Quality & Reliability

- Update frequency (near real-time vs delayed reporting)
- Accuracy validation against source repositories
- System uptime / availability of dashboard

3. Insight Generation

- # of reports produced (monthly, quarterly, program-specific)
- Identification of actionable signals:
 - At-risk or declining projects
 - High-performing / high-impact repositories
 - Gaps in maintainership or activity
- Time to detect and report critical issues (e.g., inactivity, unresolved vulnerabilities)

4. Decision-Making Impact

- # of funding or prioritization decisions informed by reporting outputs
- Evidence of intervention based on insights (e.g., maintainers added, tools funded)

- *Reduction in unidentified or “surprise” project failures over time*

5. Ecosystem Transparency & Reach

- *Engagement with published reports (views, shares, downloads)*
- *External references to Cardano development activity (research, media, partners)*
- *Community feedback on clarity and usefulness of reporting*

6. Program Effectiveness (POSM linkage)

- *Ability to trace funded activities → measurable outcomes (activity increase, issue reduction, contributor growth)*
- *% of funded projects with measurable improvement post-support*
- *ROI indicators (e.g., increased contribution velocity or reduced maintenance gaps)*

How will this work package be delivered? *

The OSC is still actively delivering on programs from the 2025 Budget cycle, introducing milestones at this stage could result in unnecessary change requests before the work has had a chance to mature.

What's the budget estimated for this Work Package?

Item #1

<i>Cost Category</i>	<i>Infrastructure ▾</i>
<i>Item Description</i>	<i>Hosting</i>
<i>Item Quantity</i>	<i>X# of Servers/APIs</i>
<i>Unit Cost</i>	<i>~6,750 ADA /month</i>
<i>Item total cost</i>	<i>81,000 ADA (inclusive of unknown tooling/transaction costs)</i>

Item #2

<i>Cost Category</i>	<i>Research ▾</i>
<i>Item Description</i>	<i>Research Based Reporting</i>
<i>Item Quantity</i>	<i>12+ Month negotiated Subscription</i>
<i>Unit Cost</i>	<i>~10,000 ADA /month</i>

Item total cost	120,000 ADA (inclusive of unknown tooling/transaction costs)
Is there any supporting material you would like to share for this Work Package? <i>Previous OS Reports</i> https://opensourcecommittee.docs.intersectmbo.org/all-monthly-reports/bitergia-repo-maturity-reports <i>Research Based Reports</i> https://opensourcecommittee.docs.intersectmbo.org/about/open-source-office-oso/cardano-s-decentralized-shift-key-players-and-impact	

Section 5 — Budget Summary

Will any portion of the requested funds be returned to the Cardano Treasury?

Any unused funds, from any program not run to completion will be returned to the Treasury.

If applicable, under what circumstances would repayment occur?

Lack of Applications from Maintainers, Tools, Tooling Projects. Event timelines, individual travel ability, over-extended event sponsorship costs. Leftover funds not used based upon negotiated contracts and partnerships.

Have you previously received funding from Cardano or related ecosystem programs?

Yes, 2025 Treasury Funding, Intersect Budget Process

Section 6 — Budget Administration

Who will be the administrator for this budget proposal if approved?

Intersect

*If approved, Intersect will act as the Administrator for this proposal. We have not selected Intersect within the form workflow because that option automatically applies the standard 3% administration fee used for third-party proposals, which does **not** apply where Intersect is administering its own approved budget allocation. This is therefore a technical form clarification rather than an indication that another Administrator would be used.*

Where Intersect administers its own proposal, the same core controls and standards apply as they do for any other vendor or funded initiative. This includes milestone-based drawdowns, supporting evidence for disbursements, transparent reporting, and independent third-party assurance over relevant deliverables. Intersect does not receive preferential treatment in the administration process and remains subject to the same accountability expectations as other recipients of Treasury funding.

Are you applying as a company or as an individual?

Intersect Committee

Who is the primary contact for this proposal?

Terence 'Tex' McCutcheon

What is the primary contact email address?

oso@intersectmbo.org

What is the transaction hash for your treasury donation?

[2f81dc78d38ad56b73acce8d50978bd2b72fd594a6dd60b9f1cd663d082633e3](#)

How will independent audits or assurance be handled for this proposal?

The OSC Chair acts as the Third Party Assurer, other audits performed by Intersect Delivery Assurance and Intersect's chosen auditor.

Independent audits and assurance for this proposal will be provided by Appold (<https://www.appold.com/>). This assurance function is intended to provide the Cardano community with additional confidence that Treasury funds are being used in line with the approved mandate, that reported milestones are supported by appropriate evidence, and that financial controls are operating effectively. Reviews may include deliverable verification, control testing, spend validation,

and assessment of milestone evidence where appropriate.

As this proposal relates to a committee budget, elected committee members will play an active role in prioritizing initiatives, assigning workstreams, and instructing Intersect in relation to approved activities within their delegated remit. Intersect's role is to operationalize those decisions through delivery coordination, contracting where required, milestone administration, and reporting. These governance and execution processes can be incorporated into the wider assurance framework to provide visibility over decision-making, delivery progress, and use of funds.

Intersect will continue to operate milestone-based drawdowns, evidence-backed reporting, and transparent disclosures alongside this external assurance process. Where recommendations are identified through audit or assurance reviews, Intersect will seek to implement reasonable improvements to strengthen accountability, efficiency, and public trust.